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White House unfreezes \$5 billion for schools

Educators relieved to be getting promised money

By Justine McDaniel and Laura Meckler

WASHINGTON POST

The Trump administration plans to release more than \$5 billion in funding to public schools that it has withheld for nearly a month, a senior administration official said Friday, ending weeks of anxiety and uncertainty for school leaders who had said the freeze jeopardized programs and staffing for the upcoming academic year.

The government placed nearly \$7 billion in funding under review June 30, then released \$1.3 billion of it last week. The administration's review of the remaining funding has ended, the official said, speaking on the condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to speak on the record.

Representative Don Bacon, Republican of Nebraska, confirmed the move on social media, saying that he pushed for the money to be released. "Exciting news to announce! All frozen education funding for the upcoming school year have been released," he wrote on X.

Lawmakers from both parties had lobbied to release the funds, which support six grant programs related to English-language learning programs, teacher training, support for children of migrant workers, and academic enrichment activities. The freeze was also being challenged in court by states and school districts.

SCHOOLS, Page A7

Amid federal grant cuts, he tracks the loss

Giant database provides details on cancellations

By Diti Kohli

GLOBE STAFF

MEDFIELD — Scott Delaney put his head in his hands and recalled the one and only time he searched the database he founded for the federal funding that pays his salary.

The Harvard University research scientist already knew money for his project — an effort to define the link between the environment and neurodegenerative disease — had been canceled. But when the grant flashed on the Grant Watch database, Delaney said, "It knocked the wind out of me."

The science has no political agenda or ideology. He and his colleagues were simply trying to give more good days to patients losing brain function, more days when they could feed themselves and chat with their grandkids. And Delaney could see no reason why the White House would stop that work.

"There was a lot of grief in that, because I know what's been lost," Delaney said of seeing the status in black and white. "The crazy thing is that there are thousands of grants in Grant Watch, and every single one of them entails loss somewhere."

For five months, Grant Watch has provided a singularly detailed account of the devastation within American scientific research, as its big-

GRANT WATCH, Page A7

Few felonies in dismissed cases

Many freed by lawyers' work stoppage face low-level charges

By Sean Cotter

GLOBE STAFF

Judge Tracy-Lee Lyons ticked through the backlogged cases in a matter of minutes. Drug possession charge? Dismiss. Another drug possession charge? Dismiss. Several shoplifting charges. Dismiss, dismiss, dismiss.

Then, came one involving an allegation of violence: a domestic assault and battery charge that Lyons, chief justice of Boston Municipal Court, also dismissed before return-

ing to the string of drug possession cases and petty theft before her.

The hearing this week in a musty room in BMC's downtown courthouse that resulted in the dismissal of 100 criminal cases was triggered by a work stoppage by court-appointed attorneys that's left thousands of indigent defendants without lawyers. The courts have invoked an emergency procedure to protect the constitutional right to representation by releasing some defendants from custody and dismiss-

ing other cases outright.

While the mounting number of dismissals prompted prosecutors to warn of risks to public safety, a Globe analysis of the dropped cases shows a more mundane reality: the high proportion of low-level crimes clogging the court system, particularly the district courts where the work stoppage is concentrated.

About three-quarters of the 100 dismissed cases involved misdemeanors rather than felonies, closely mirroring the most recent state-

wide data of all charges filed in district courts. A little more than one-quarter of the cases involved assaults, including 12 that allegedly included a dangerous weapon and nine involving allegations of domestic violence.

Now, as the Suffolk district attorney's office begins an effort to reopen those cases, defense attorneys say there needs to be a balance struck between public safety and due process.

The cases were dismissed without prejudice, meaning prosecutors

BAR ADVOCATES, Page A10

BIRD'S EYE VIEW



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

A pedestrian passed by a peacock mural on the building housing MaMa Africa, an African fashion store, in Pawtucket, R.I.

The law school grad taking on Harvard

Trump aide says a deal offers university a shot to get things right

By Tal Kopan and Aidan Ryan

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When she graduated from Harvard Law School, May Mailman didn't expect to find herself one day representing the White House on the other side of a high-stakes negotiation with her alma mater. In fact, she enjoyed her time at the university and the opportunities she had there.

But as a senior policy official for President Trump, Mailman has become a point person on the administration's campaign to bring higher education to heel, telling the Globe in an interview that the administration's goal is to make Harvard better.

"It doesn't feel like I'm against Harvard," Mailman said. "It feels like this is a moment for them to say out loud,

'These are our values.'"

To get Harvard to that point, the administration has implemented a multi-pronged pressure campaign that includes canceling nearly \$3 billion in federal grants, attempting to block visas for international students and staff, and threatening the university's accreditation.

Mailman, a 2015 law school graduate, is the White House's senior policy strategist and a deputy assistant to the president. She is a right hand to deputy chief of staff Stephen Miller, atop the nerve center of the White House on Trump's policy priorities. That includes Trump's current campaign against Harvard and other universities under the stated objective of ending diversity policies the administration considers discriminatory and combating antisemitism, particularly the protests and environment on campuses

MAILMAN, Page A6

INSIDE THE WAR ON HARVARD

'It doesn't feel like I'm against Harvard. It feels like this is a moment for them to say out loud, "These are our values.'"

MAY MAILMAN, Senior policy official at the White House

Tens of thousands of people sought refuge as border fighting between Thailand and Cambodia entered a second day. **A4.**

Israel will allow foreign nations to parachute humanitarian aid to a population in the Gaza Strip desperate for food. **A5.**

Cambridge officials expect to spend as much as \$20 million in public funds to demolish the evacuated Riverview Condominium building. **B1.**

Governor Maura Healey named four new members to a restructured Health Policy Commission, the agency responsible for controlling health care costs, and reappointed two previous members. **D1.**



Heat and greet

Saturday: Less humid. High: 77-82. Low: 65-70.
Sunday: Clouds and sun. High: 75-80. Low: 64-69.
Sunrise: 5:31 Sunset: 8:10
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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Concession workers unhappy with pay launch strike before Sox game



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Kristina Evans, who has worked at Fenway Park for 19 years, shouted at ballpark employees reporting for their shifts.

Outside Fenway, employees urge fans to support them

By Yogev Toby

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Fenway Park concession workers walked off the job Friday ahead of a three-day series between the Red Sox and the Los Angeles Dodgers as negotiations with the ballpark's concession company failed to produce a contract agreement.

Coming just hours before tens of thousands of fans arrived for the night game, the walkout is the first time concession workers have gone on strike in Fenway's 113-year history, according to the union, Unite Here Local 26. The roughly 1,000 striking workers

are seeking higher wages and limits on automated checkout kiosks they say cut into their tips and threaten their jobs.

"We decided we had to do something about this," said Camille Belle, 88, who has worked as a cashier at Fenway for the past 18 years. "I never thought it would come to this, but here it is."

Fans arrived on a humid Friday night to the sight of a wall of more than 100 workers dressed in green near the entrances to Fenway, some banging on drums that echoed around the streets outside the country's oldest ballpark.

"I hope they hear us in the office," said Kristina Evans, who has been at Fenway for 19 years. "I hope they hear us loud and proud."

The Fenway concession workers earn an average wage of \$18 an hour, the union said, and are asking for "citywide standard wages," pointing to the \$20 to \$26 the concession company, Aramark, pays workers at Boston University, according to the union.

Aramark said in a statement that it has contingency plans to provide concessions to fans during the strike.

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